

The Economic and Financial Environment of Global Business

Fall 2026

Course:	BUS 313
Section / CRN:	007 / 80349
Prerequisites:	ECON 130 and ECON 131, or consent of the instructor
Lecture Time:	Wednesdays and Fridays, 1:30–2:45 p.m.
Location:	BUSAD G102
Instructor:	Muhammad Talal Khan
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Office Hours:	By Appointment

1 Course Objectives

This course develops the economic reasoning and analytical skills students need to interpret international business conditions and make informed decisions in globally integrated markets. Building on the introductory economics sequence, it applies economic theory to practical business challenges, with particular emphasis on the Asia-Pacific region. By the end of the course, students will be able to:

1. Analyze comparative advantage and the major models of international trade.
2. Evaluate how trade barriers and policies affect firms, industries, and markets.
3. Interpret balance-of-payments accounts and analyze how exchange-rate movements influence international trade, investment, and business activity.
4. Assess the roles of banking systems, multinational corporations, and international economic institutions in the global economy.
5. Evaluate the causes, transmission mechanisms, and business consequences of global financial crises.
6. Compare major regional economic issues, with particular emphasis on the Asia-Pacific region.
7. Apply ethical and legal principles to international business decisions, including compliance with the U.S. Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA).
8. Apply international economic concepts and data to evaluate global business opportunities, risks, and strategic decisions.

2 Materials

Required Textbook: Gerber, J. *International Economics* (8th ed.). Pearson Education, Inc. *MyEconLab* is required for this course. Students may obtain access in either of the following ways:

- Purchase a MyLab Economics access card with eText through the UH Bookstore.
- Purchase the eBook with access to MyEconLab.
- Purchase the eBook with access to MyEconLab. I will assign homeworks through MyEconLab and you will be able to access the homework related part of the eBook.

Register through the Pearson link in Lamakū using your UH email address.

Lecture Notes and Readings: Lecture notes, readings, videos, articles, and web links referenced in class will be posted on Lamakū. Students are encouraged to download the lecture notes before class to facilitate note-taking and comprehension. The current syllabus, including any revisions, will also be available on Lamakū.

3 Requirements

Attendance

Attendance is highly recommended. Experience indicates a strong positive relationship between regular attendance and exam performance. In addition, UH Executive Policy EP 7.209 requires faculty to verify initial student participation in coursework for federal financial-aid compliance.

Homework

Six online homework assignments will reinforce the principal concepts and provide practice applying the analytical tools introduced in class. All assignments must be completed through the *Assignments* tab in Pearson MyLab Economics:

- **Homework 1:** Chapters 1 and 2
- **Homework 2:** Chapter 3
- **Homework 3:** Chapters 4 and 5
- **Homework 4:** Chapter 6
- **Homework 5:** Chapter 9
- **Homework 6:** Chapters 10 and 11

Group Project

Students will work in groups of four to five to deliver one presentation. Each group will be assigned a specific topic related to evaluating a country as a potential location for conducting business. Additional instructions and presentation details will be provided in class.

Examinations

There will be two closed-book, closed-note examinations:

- **Midterm examination:** Chapters 1 through 7.
- **Final examination:** The examination will be comprehensive, with emphasis on Chapters 9, 10, 11, and 12.

Students must provide a written medical excuse for an exam absence. If a make-up examination is authorized, it will be scheduled at the instructor's discretion. A make-up may differ in format or difficulty from the original examination and may be subject to an appropriate point deduction. Requests to review a possible grading error must be made within one week after examination results are posted.

Submission Deadlines

Assignments generally open on the first class meeting devoted to the relevant material and are due approximately one and one-half weeks after that material is completed. Students are responsible for submitting each assignment in MyLab by the posted date and time; the MyLab submission record determines whether work was completed on time.

Late homework is generally not accepted. However, exceptions may be considered at the instructor's sole discretion on a case-by-case basis when sufficient documentation is provided to verify a valid reason. The instructor reserves the right to determine whether an exception is warranted, the conditions under which late work may be accepted, and any applicable penalties or adjustments to the assignment grade.

Grading

The course grade will be based on the weighted total of homework and examination scores. The instructor may apply a reasonable curve to the overall class distribution.

Component	Weight
Homework	40%
Group Project	10%
Midterm examination	25%
Final examination	25%
Total	100%

Letter grades reflect overall mastery of the course learning outcomes. Plus and minus grades may be assigned to distinguish performance within each letter grade.

- **A:** Outstanding mastery and application of course concepts.
- **B:** Above-average mastery and application of course concepts.
- **C:** Satisfactory mastery and application of course concepts.
- **D:** Limited mastery and application of course concepts.
- **F:** Insufficient mastery and application of course concepts.

Course Communication

Official course announcements, assignment information, updated files, and schedule changes will be posted in Lamakū. Students should check the course site and their UH email regularly. Email is the preferred method for arranging an appointment with the instructor.

4 Administration

Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities are encouraged to contact the instructor and the KOKUA Program as early as possible to arrange appropriate accommodations. KOKUA is the UH Mānoa office for students with disabilities and is located in QLCSS 013. For information, visit hawaii.edu/kokua, email kokua@hawaii.edu, or call (808) 956-7511. Students who receive an accommodation letter should provide it to the instructor promptly so that approved arrangements can be implemented in a timely manner.

Academic Honesty

Students are expected to act responsibly in their interactions with members of the UH Mānoa community, respect the interests of the University, and comply with the UH Student Conduct Code (Available at: http://www.studentaffairs.manoa.hawaii.edu/policies/conduct_code/). As per the code:

Cheating includes, but is not limited to:

1. Use of any unauthorized assistance in taking quizzes, tests, or examinations.
2. Use of sources beyond those authorized by the instructor in writing papers, preparing reports, solving problems, or carrying out other assignments.
3. The acquisition, without permission, of tests or other academic material belonging to a member of the UH faculty, staff, or student.
4. Engaging in any behavior specifically prohibited by a faculty member in the course syllabus or class discussion.

Plagiarism includes, but is not limited to:

1. The use, by paraphrase or direct quotation, of the published or unpublished work of another person without full and clear acknowledgement.
2. The unacknowledged use of artificial-intelligence output or materials prepared by another person, agency, or commercial service.

All incidents will be handled in accordance with the UH Student Code of Conduct.

Disclaimer

All information in this syllabus is subject to change as deemed necessary by the instructor. Changes may be communicated verbally during class, by email, through Lamakū, or by other course communication methods at the instructor's discretion.

5 Tentative Course Schedule

Important dates appear in **red**.

WEDNESDAY		FRIDAY	
08/26	Syllabus and course logistics Ch. 1: The United States in the Global Economy	08/28	Ch. 2: International Economic Institutions since World War II
09/02	Ch. 3: Comparative Advantage and the Gains from Trade	09/04	Ch. 3, continued
09/09	Review of Ch. 3 and preparation for Homework 2	09/11	Ch. 4: Comparative Advantage and Factor Endowments Homework 1 due
09/16	Ch. 4, continued	09/18	Ch. 5: Beyond Comparative Advantage
09/23	Review of Chapters 4–5 Homework 2 due	09/25	Ch. 6: The Theory of Tariffs and Quotas
09/30	Ch. 6, continued	10/02	Ch. 7: Commercial Policy
10/07	Ch. 7, continued Homework 3 due	10/09	Review of Chapters 6–7 and preparation for Homework 4
10/14	Sample midterm examination and solutions	10/16	Questions and answers for the midterm Homework 4 due
10/21	MIDTERM EXAMINATION	10/23	Ch. 9: Trade and the Balance of Payments
10/28	Review of midterm examination and solutions	10/30	Ch. 9, continued
11/04	Review of Ch. 9 and preparation for Homework 5	11/06	Ch. 10: Exchange Rates and Exchange-Rate Systems Homework 5 due
11/11	VETERANS DAY – NO CLASS	11/13	Ch. 10, continued
11/18	Ch. 10, continued	11/20	Ch. 11: Introduction to Open-Economy Macroeconomics
11/25	Review of Chapters 10–11 and preparation for Homework 6	11/27	THANKSGIVING RECESS – NO CLASS
12/02	Ch. 12: International Financial Crises	12/04	Ch. 12, continued Homework 6 due
12/09	Sample final examination, solutions, and course review	12/11	GROUP PRESENTATIONS
FINAL EXAMINATION: DATE, TIME, AND LOCATION TBA			